

OMER AKBEN

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SUMMARY

AI Engineer & Full-Stack Developer with 6+ years across QA automation and software engineering. Build production LLM features (OpenAI/Claude, Responses API, RAG/embeddings/vector DBs) in TypeScript/Python and ship them with SDET-grade test coverage (Playwright, Jest) and CI/CD (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Docker). Former Test Automation Architect with deep Selenium/SpecFlow/TestNG expertise; comfortable across Next.js/React front-ends and FastAPI/Node back-ends. Delivered measurable outcomes in fintech, healthcare, and education with an emphasis on reliability, privacy, and performance.

Keywords: LLMs, OpenAI, Claude, Responses API, RAG, embeddings, pgvector/FAISS, prompt engineering, Next.js, React, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, Node.js, Playwright, Selenium, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Docker, PostgreSQL, MongoDB.

CORE SKILLS

AI/LLMs: OpenAI & Anthropic SDKs (Responses API, tools/actions), ChatKit (widget/studio), Agent Builder (Agents SDK / AgentKit — A2A orchestration), LangChain, LangGraph, Vertex AI, RAG, embeddings, retrieval, vector stores (pgvector/FAISS), guardrails/safety

Frontend: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, component & state patterns, SSR/ISR, accessibility & performance

Backend: Python (FastAPI), Node.js/Express, REST APIs, GraphQL, auth (JWT/OAuth), structured error handling, observability hooks

QA/SDET: Playwright (E2E/API), Selenium WebDriver, SpecFlow/Cucumber, TestNG/JUnit/MSTest, Jest/Vitest, API/contract testing, ETL validation (HL7/PHI)

DevOps/CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Docker, quality gates, code review workflows, Selenium Grid

Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL Server, schema design, data validation & integrity

Practices: TDD/BDD, shift-left QA, documentation/knowledge-sharing, mentoring

EXPERIENCE

AI Full-Stack Software Engineer — Freelance | Remote — Raleigh, NC

Jan 2024 – Present

- Built customizable AI chat apps for higher-ed using Next.js + TypeScript with OpenAI/Claude backends; added prompt tooling, conversation memory, and role-based access. Integrated Playwright suites in CI/CD to prevent regressions.
- Shipped an AI toolbar add-on to streamline LLM access across web apps; implemented least-privilege access, logging, and security/privacy controls.
- Delivered 15+ workflow automations (Zapier/n8n/Make) and LLM-powered extraction that cut repetitive work ~60%; added observability and retries.
- Built internal REST APIs (Node + FastAPI) with input validation, error taxonomy, and automated tests reaching >90% coverage on critical paths.
- Maintains omerakben.com: Next.js, TypeScript, OpenAI ChatKit embed, Vercel CI/CD, Lighthouse/performance tuning, and Playwright E2E.
- Architecture: ChatKit widget ↔ Agent Builder (Responses API + tools/actions) ↔ RAG over Postgres/pgvector for retrieval; analytics, feedback capture, and evals wired into CI for continuous improvement.

Stack: TypeScript, Next.js/React, Node, FastAPI, OpenAI/Anthropic, ChatKit, Agent Builder/AgentKit, Playwright, Jest, Docker, Azure DevOps, Git, PostgreSQL (pgvector), MongoDB, Zapier, n8n.

Test Automation Architect (SDET) — Oteemo | Remote

Feb 2024 – Sep 2024

- Sole SDET consultant for a Fortune-500 financial services end client: transformed an empty Azure DevOps repo (README-only) into a production-grade, assetized test automation framework built from scratch.
- Multi-environment setup: established developer and testing environments with config isolation; Dockerized local runner; codified standards in a reusable starter repo for rapid onboarding.
- Framework engineering: C#.NET Selenium + MSTest, Page Objects, data factories, and an API client layer (RestSharp); stability-first waits/retries delivered ~98% pass rates on mature suites.
- Adoption & mentorship: client teams copied and adopted my utility classes, setup patterns, and build techniques; produced docs/runbooks and provided hands-on mentoring to raise automation proficiency.
- Beyond SDET scope: supported internal client projects with repository structure and build best practices after they saw my coding approach.

Stack: C#, .NET, Selenium, MSTest, RestSharp, Azure DevOps (Repos), Docker, SQL Server, Git, NuGet.

QA Engineer — ECS (Engineering Consulting Services) | Raleigh, NC (Hybrid)

Apr 2023 – Jan 2024

- Refactored utilities & core helpers: rewrote utility classes, generic methods, and static helpers; increased team velocity ~20% via cleaner abstractions and reuse.
- API test automation at scale: converted manual API tests into Postman Collections with JavaScript test scripts; reduced manual-tester backlog ~10% and improved repeatability.
- Enablement & mentoring: trained manual testers to run automation scripts and author simple cases; established templates and checklists for consistent contributions.
- UI automation stability: modernized Page Object patterns to Page Factory; improved stability to ~95% pass rate and cut maintenance ~30%.

Stack: C#, MSTest, Selenium, RestSharp, Azure DevOps, D365, SQL Server, Postman.

SDET / QA Test Automation Engineer — Xsolis | Franklin, TN (Remote)

Oct 2022 – Apr 2023

- Healthcare ETL/UI/API automation: built automated flows for HL7/PHI pipelines using Selenium + SpecFlow (BDD); expanded coverage 40%→85% and reduced manual effort ~30%.
- Cross-vendor collaboration: worked with outsourced automation partner (EPAM) to align frameworks, coding standards, and review practices.
- Tooling & platforms: used Atlassian (Jira/Confluence), Azure DevOps, qTest for test case management; created shared Postman collections to speed inter-team collaboration.
- Unit/API layers: contributed xUnit test coverage and API verifications to support service regression and contract checks.

Stack: C#, .NET, Selenium, SpecFlow (BDD), xUnit, SQL, Azure, Jira/Confluence, qTest, Postman.

SDET / QA Automation Engineer — Fannie Mae | Washington, DC (Remote)

Apr 2021 – Sep 2022

- Java-based UI/API automation (Selenium + TestNG + REST Assured); improved release velocity ~10% with ~20% automated coverage on key modules.
- Built Jenkins pipelines and Selenium Grid autoscaling to run 50+ concurrent tests; reduced regression time ~15%.
- Added automated API contract tests across microservices to prevent breaking changes.

Stack: Java, Selenium, TestNG, REST Assured, Jenkins, Selenium Grid, Git/Maven.

QA Automation Engineer — Delaware State Chamber of Commerce | Wilmington, DE (Hybrid)

Sep 2018 – Mar 2021

- Stood up a Java/Selenium/JUnit framework integrated with Jenkins; increased automated coverage ~35% and lowered API defects ~30%.
- Wrote SQL validation across 50+ tables for data-integrity checks.

Stack: Java, Selenium, JUnit, Jenkins, SQL, Git/Maven.

PROJECTS (SELECTED)

AI Chat — University client — Next.js/TypeScript • FastAPI • OpenAI/Claude • ChatKit • Agent Builder • pgvector • Microsoft Entra ID (auth) • Playwright

- Role-based access and conversation memory; architecture: ChatKit widget → Agent Builder → RAG (Postgres/pgvector) with guardrails; auth via Microsoft Entra ID.
- Full E2E via Playwright; documentation and onboarding for 200+ faculty/staff.

Portfolio App — omerakben.com — Next.js/TypeScript • Vercel CI/CD • Playwright • ChatKit

- Production portfolio with ChatKit embed, analytics, perf budgets, Lighthouse tuning, Playwright smoke/regression.
- Design-system foundation; integrates selected components from tuel for complex UI motion.

Nonprofit Automation Playbooks (Greensboro, NC) — Google Workspace • n8n • Zapier/Make • Postman • LLMs

- End-to-end intake → enrichment → routing pipeline (Forms/Email/Sheets/CRM) with status tracking, retries, alerts, and dashboards.
- Authored shared Postman collections and runbooks; trained volunteers/staff; templated flows for safe reuse.

tuel (npm) — React Animation Components — TypeScript • ESM • Storybook

- Component utilities for page/section transitions; tree-shakable, typed, CI-tested.
- Used in omerakben.com and internal showcases.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Nashville Software School — Full-Stack Web Developer Bootcamp | Nashville, TN | 2024–2025

Key topics: JavaScript/TypeScript, React/Next.js, Python/FastAPI, Django, TDD, CI/CD

TechCenture Academy — Full-Stack Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) | Fairfax, VA | 2017–2018

Istanbul Okan University — Master of Science in Healthcare | Istanbul, Turkey | 2014–2016

Agentic AI Course for Software Development — in progress